

The Red-Flag Guide (How to Spot the Trap)

Prepared by: Favour Chiemela

Target Audience: NGO Staff Members (10 Persons)

The goal of this guide is to break down the exact tricks used in the Tony Elumelu Foundation simulation email so the team can learn how to spot them next time.

1. Emotional and Psychological Red Flags

Scammers usually attack human emotions before they attack the computer. In this email, two main tricks were used to confuse the staff:

- **The Fear Factor:** The email mentions the **Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN)** and warns that the NGO's "**bank account could be frozen.**" This is meant to cause instant panic so the staff member stops thinking clearly and acts out of fear.
- **Artificial Urgency:** The email gives a strict **24-hour deadline** to fix the issue. Scammers use deadlines to make you rush. When a worker is rushing, they easily miss small mistakes and click links without checking them first.

2. Technical and Visual Red Flags

If you look very closely at the sender details and the link, you will see the physical mistakes the scammer made:

- **The Typo in the Domain Name:** The fake email use: `info@tonyelumeIu-foundation.org`
 - The real website is: info@tonyelumelufoundation.org
 - The trick: The scammer added a **hyphen (-)** and changed the second lowercase letter "l" in Elumelu to a capital letter "I". On a phone or laptop screen, a lowercase l and a capital I look almost exactly the same, making it a very dangerous trap for a busy worker.
- **Insecure HTTP Connection:**
 - The link starts with `http://` instead of `https://`.
 - The trick: The missing "S" means the webpage is not secure or encrypted. A real organization like the Tony Elumelu Foundation will never ask you to type login details into an insecure `http` website.

Conclusion for the Team

Whenever an email brings sudden bad news or asks you to click a link to solve a problem with your bank or a grant, don't use the link inside the email. Always open a fresh browser tab and log into the official website yourself, or call the organization directly to verify.